

Biblioteca

Guia do Usuário

Versão do programa: 1.9.20

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Introdução

O que o programa faz

Biblioteca is the catalogue of your books on Android. It keeps the title, authors, subjects, year, country, where the copy is, whether it is on loan and your own notes — and shows all of it in a list you can search and filter. It is the same catalogue as the Mac, Windows and iPhone apps: all four read and write the SAME file, biblioteca.txt. What you add on the phone shows up on the computer, and the other way round. On the phone it has the camera: you can point it at the barcode on the back cover and the book is added for you, with title, authors and year looked up from the ISBN.

Informações de entrada

A folder on your phone or in your cloud with a file called biblioteca.txt inside. That is what the app reads, and what it writes to. You choose the folder once, under Sync, and the app remembers. If you do not have that file yet, the app creates one: pick the folder and use "Create biblioteca.txt in this folder". The chapter "The first time" shows the whole path. Looking books up by ISBN and fetching covers from the internet need a connection. Everything else works offline.

Resultados produzidos

biblioteca.txt itself, updated on every change. It is a plain text file, one book per line with tab-separated fields — you can open it in any editor, and it does not depend on this app to be read. The Countries screen also gives you a count of books by country of origin. Covers you take with the camera are kept on the device itself. Covers are published into biblioteca.dat, for the other devices to see, by the Mac and iPhone apps.

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Instalação

There are two ways in, and both install exactly the same version. It works on Android 7 or newer.

From the Play Store (closed test)

Biblioteca is in a closed test. Without accepting the invitation the app does not show up in the store — and the invitation needs a Google account.

1. Accept the closed-test invitation with the same Google address you use on the phone.
2. Open the Play Store link that came with it and tap Install.
3. If you already have Biblioteca, tap Update. Your books and covers stay where they are.

From the .apk file

If your address is not a Google one, or the invitation does not open, install the file directly. It is the same version.

1. Download Biblioteca-Android.apk from https://ruggierow.github.io/biblioteca/. Chrome warns that this kind of file can be dangerous: tap "Download anyway".
2. Tap the downloaded file — from the notification, or in My Files › Downloads.
3. Android says it cannot install apps from unknown sources and offers a Settings button: tap it and allow. Go back and tap Install.
4. On newer Galaxy phones, Auto Blocker stops this BEFORE that and does not offer the shortcut. Go to Settings › Security and privacy › Auto Blocker and turn it off; then tap the file again.
5. Do not uninstall the old version first: it is updated in place and everything is preserved. Uninstalling first erases the covers kept on the device.

Como confirmar que a instalação funcionou

The app opens on the home screen, with the blue header, the name Biblioteca and, just below, how many books were loaded. The first time the number is zero and the "File" band at the bottom says "No file linked" — that is expected, and the next chapter sorts it out.

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The home screen

It is the starting point for everything. The header shows how many books are loaded, the language and the version; below it, the app's five paths; and at the bottom, the "File" band, which says which file it is working with.

Passo a passo

1. "Scan a book" opens the camera to read the barcode on the back cover.
2. "Add a book" opens the form for a new book, to fill in by hand.
3. "Countries" shows where your books come from.
4. "Search" opens the whole list, with search and filters.
5. "Sync" is where you choose the folder and re-read the file.
6. To change the language, tap the "PT" or "EN" beside the globe, in the header, and choose.

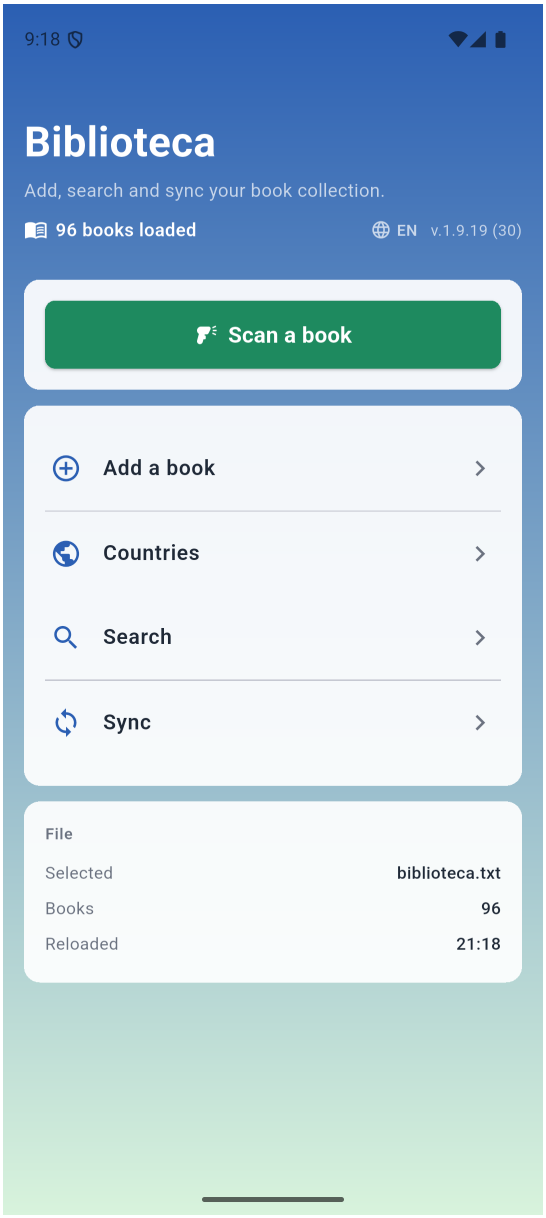


Figura 1: The home screen, with the five paths and the file band

Exemplos de uso

- The number of books loaded is the quickest check there is: if it is zero when it should not be, the problem is the file, not your entries.
- The first time, the language follows the device. Once you pick one in the selector, your choice always wins.

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The first time: the folder and the file

This is the one step you cannot skip. The app does not make up where to keep your books: you choose the folder, once. And if that folder does not have a biblioteca.txt yet, the app creates one. You do not have to produce the file elsewhere, nor on a computer.

Passo a passo

1. On the home screen, tap "Sync".
2. Tap "Select folder". Android's picker opens.
3. Choose the folder where your biblioteca.txt is — or where you want it to be. Tap "USE THIS FOLDER" and then "ALLOW".
4. If there was a biblioteca.txt there, you are done: the "File" band now shows the name and the book count.
5. If there was not, the row "Create biblioteca.txt in this folder" appears. Tap it: the app creates the file and writes there from then on.

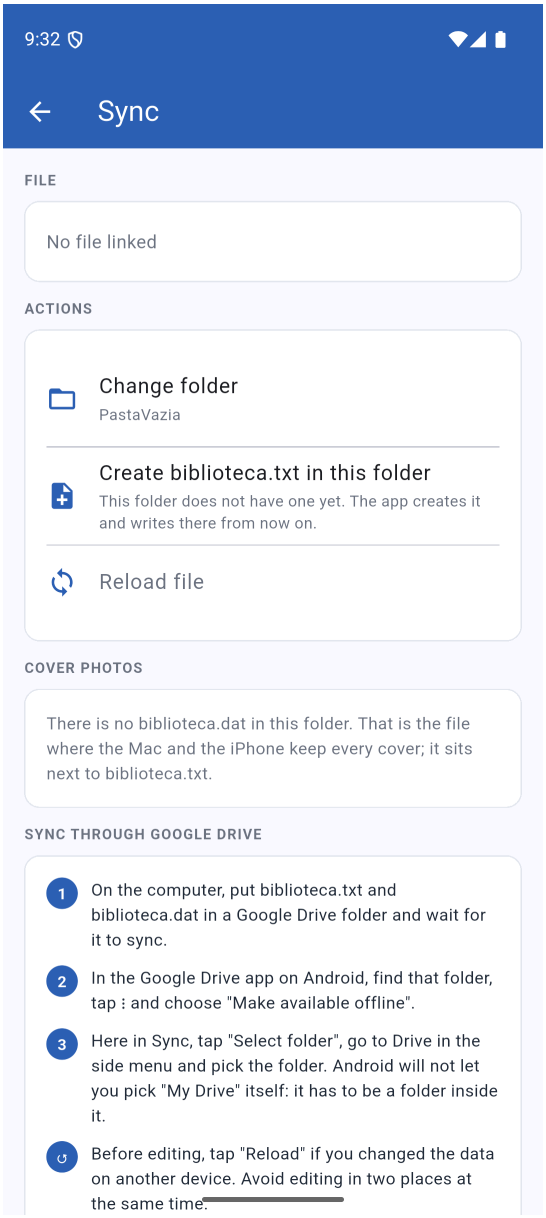


Figura 2: The Sync screen when the folder has no file, with the row that creates it

Exemplos de uso

- Android refuses roots. "My Drive" and the internal storage come back with the "Use this folder" button greyed out and the warning "To protect your privacy, choose another folder". Go into a SUBFOLDER — inside Google Drive it works normally.
- Which folder to choose: if you use the app on more than one device, pick a cloud folder the computer can see too — a Google Drive subfolder, for instance. If you only use the phone, any folder will do.
- "Create biblioteca.txt in this folder" writes the list currently in view. Starting from scratch it is empty, and out comes a file ready for your first book.
- With no folder linked, "Add a book" does not open. That is not a fault: with no file there is nowhere to write the book.

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Adding a book

The form has three parts: the ISBN lookup at the top, the cover photo in the middle and the book's details below. The only required field is the title.

Passo a passo

1. Tap "Add a book" on the home screen.
2. If you have the ISBN, type it and tap the magnifier: title, authors and year come filled in.
3. Tap "Photograph the cover" to use the camera, if you want the cover.
4. Fill in the Title, the Year of publication and Where the copy is.
5. Tap "+ Add author" once per author and "+ Add subject" once per subject.
6. Scroll to the bottom for the Country, the Reading Group, the On loan state and the Notes.
7. Tap "Save", in the top right corner. The file is written at once.

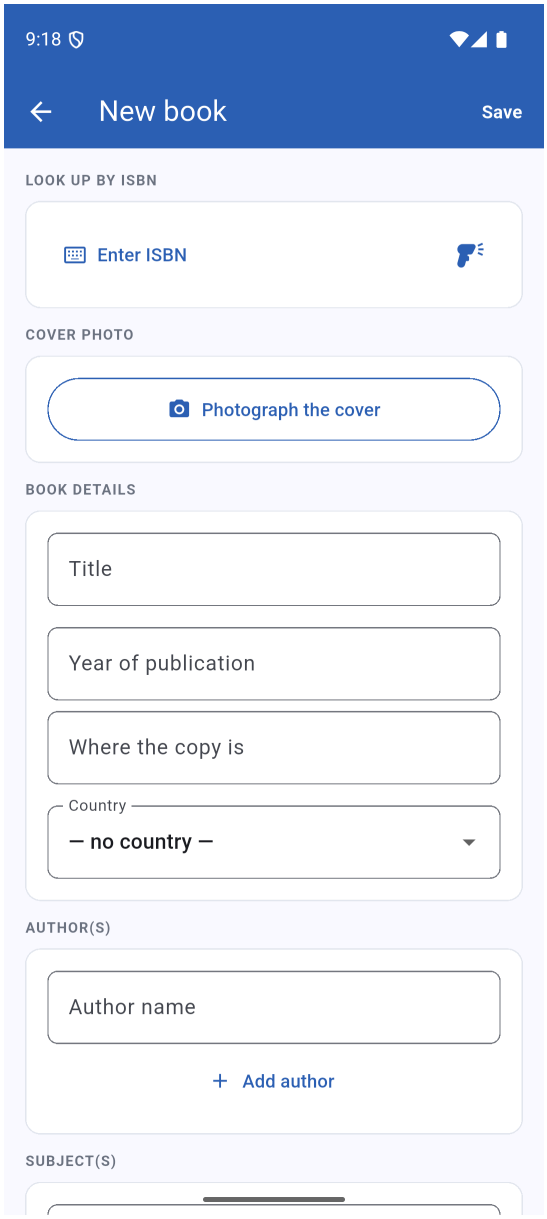


Figura 3: The top of the form: ISBN, cover photo and the first fields

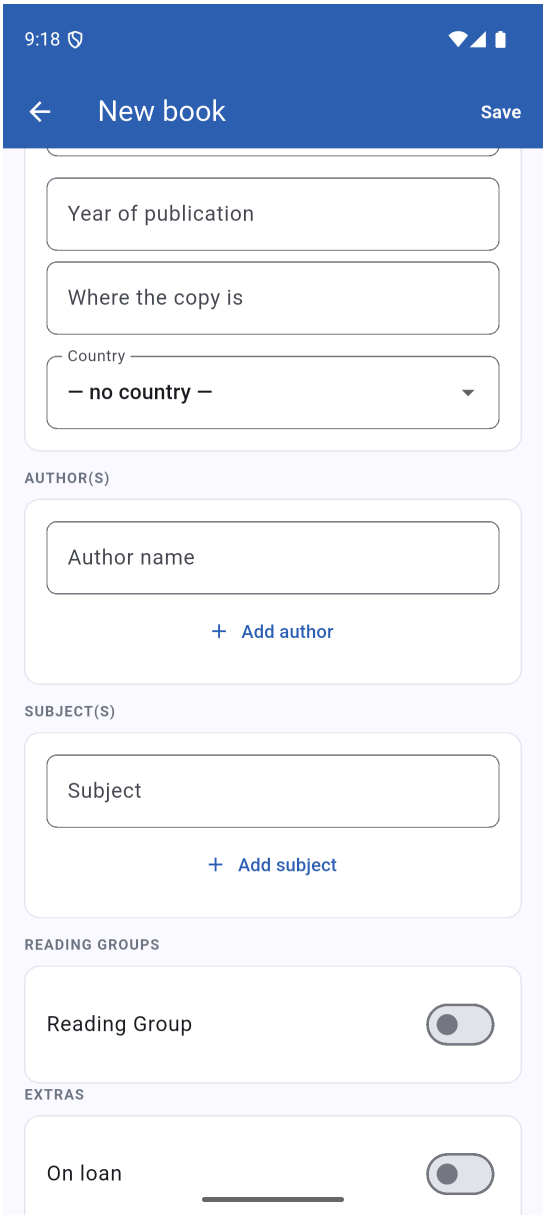


Figura 4: The rest of the form: authors, subjects, group and loan

Exemplos de uso

- Scanning beats typing: from the home screen, "Scan a book" reads the barcode and opens the form already filled in.
- The camera is only asked for when you use the camera. If you deny the permission, all the rest of the app keeps working.

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Search

It opens the whole list, with the count at the top. The search box looks in title, author, subject and location at the same time; the filter icon in the corner adds status, group and country.

Passo a passo

1 Tap "Search" on the home screen.

2 Type a piece of what you are looking for — it need not be the whole word, and case does not matter.

3 Tap the filter icon to narrow by status, reading group or country.

4 Tap a book to open its record.

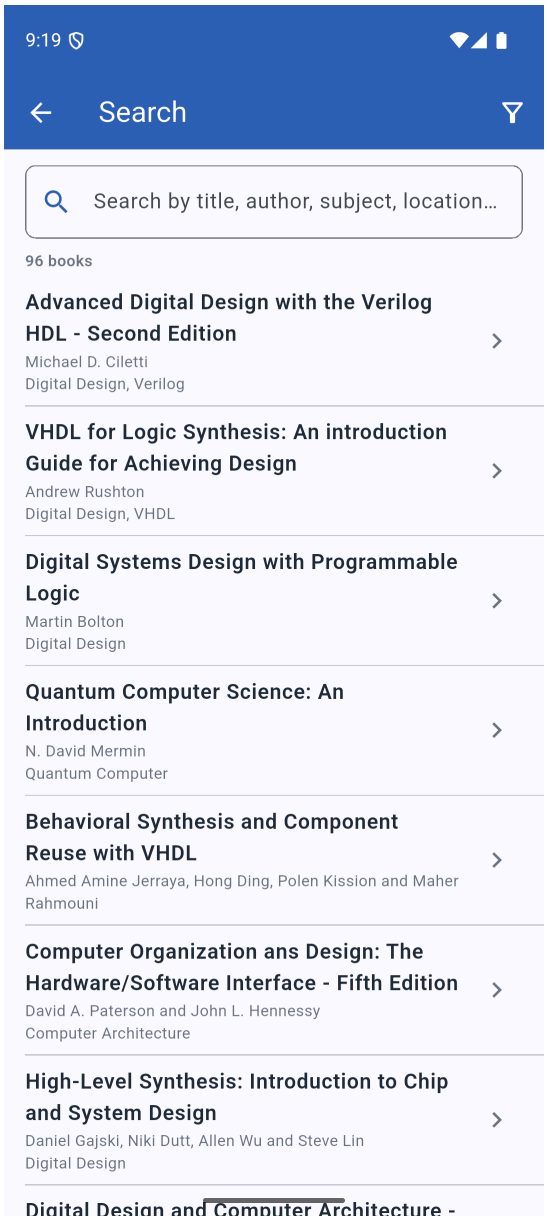


Figura 5: Search, with the count at the top and the list below

Exemplos de uso

- The count at the top says how many books the current filter let through. It is how you check that the search did what you expected.
- Searching by location — "shelf 3" — is the quickest way to find a book at home.

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The book's record

It shows everything kept about that book, in sections: the cover, the identification, the authors, the subjects, the status and your notes. The "Edit" button at the top opens the same form as adding, with the details filled in.

Passo a passo

1 In search, tap the book.

2 Scroll to see the subjects, the status and the notes.

3 Tap "Edit" to correct any field.

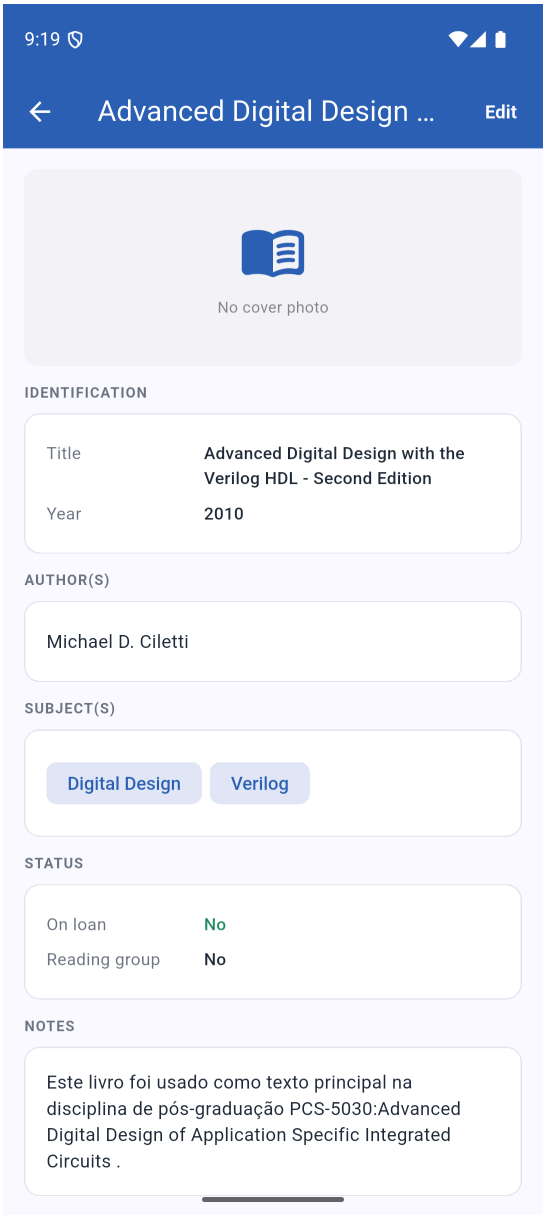


Figura 6: A book's record, with the cover and the sections

Exemplos de uso

- Sections with nothing in them do not appear: a book with no subjects simply has no Subject(s) section, instead of showing an empty one.
- When a note has a web address in it, it becomes a link right there.

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Countries

The count of books by country of origin, largest first, with a bar giving each one's share. A book's country is where the literature comes from, not where the edition was printed.

Passo a passo

1 Tap "Countries" on the home screen.

2 The top line says how many books have a country and across how many countries they fall.

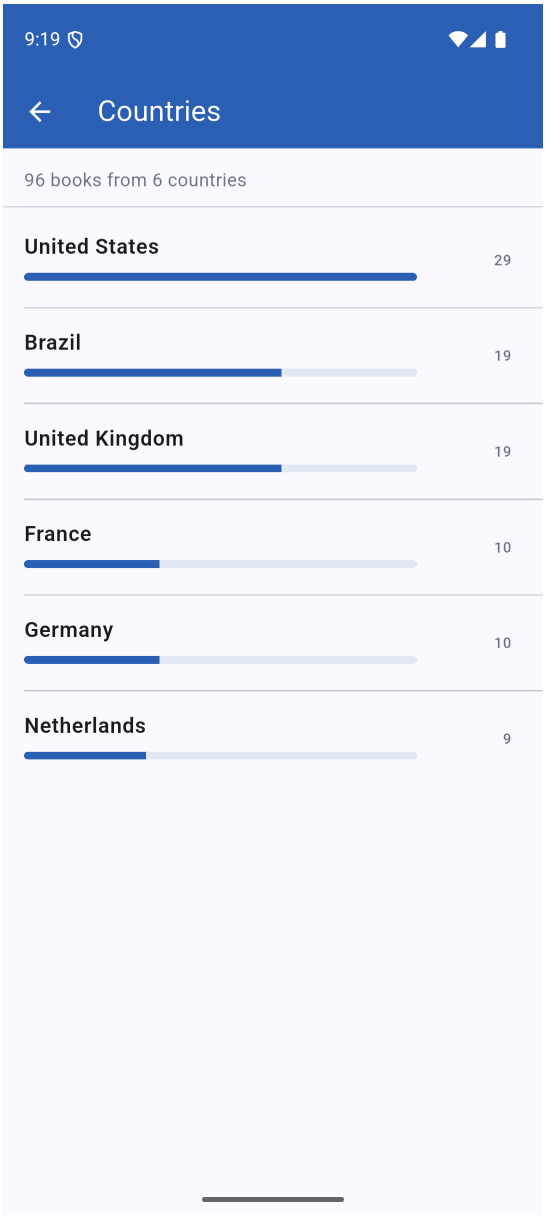


Figura 7: The count by country, with the proportion bar

Exemplos de uso

- The country is optional. Books with no country are left out of the count, and the screen says how many there are.
- To give a book a country, open its record, tap Edit and pick one in the Country field.

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Sync

This is the file screen. It says which one is linked, how many books came from it and at what time; it offers to change folder and to reload; and at the bottom it explains how to make the phone and the computer see the same collection.

Passo a passo

1 "Change folder" picks another folder — and shows the current one's name below.

2 "Reload file" reads the file again. Use it after changing the library on another device.

3 The "Cover photos" section says whether there is a biblioteca.dat in the folder, and what it is.

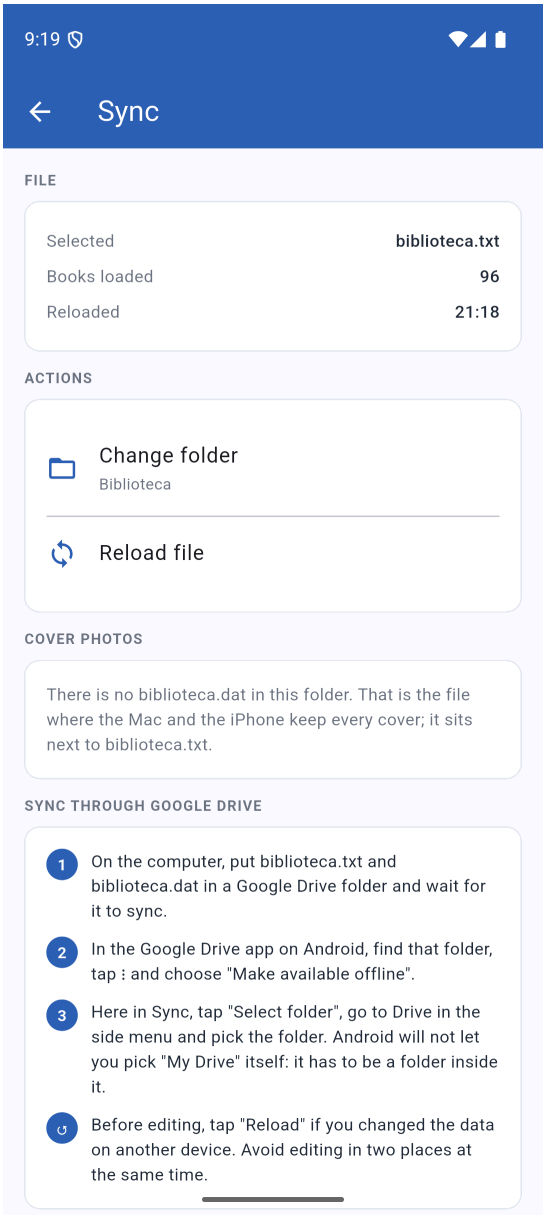


Figura 8: The Sync screen, with the file linked

Exemplos de uso

- There is no save button: every change is written at once. The "Saved" time in the file band is the proof of that.
- biblioteca.dat is where the Mac and the iPhone keep every cover. Android READS it to show the covers that came from there, but does not write to it: photos you take here stay on the device.
- Avoid editing the same library on two devices at the same time. Whoever writes last wins.

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Tutorial: from nothing to your first book

This is the whole path for someone who has just installed the app and has no file at all. At the end of it you come out with the folder chosen, biblioteca.txt created and a book in it.

1. Open the app. It shows 0 books and "No file linked" — that is expected.
2. Tap "Sync" and then "Select folder".
3. In the picker, go into a subfolder — of Google Drive, if you want the computer to see it too. Tap "USE THIS FOLDER" and "ALLOW".
4. Since the folder is empty, "Create biblioteca.txt in this folder" appears. Tap it. The "File" band now shows the file's name.
5. Go back to the home screen and tap "Scan a book". Point the camera at the barcode on the back cover of a book you have at hand.
6. The form opens with title, authors and year filled in. Check them, write in Where the copy is where the book sits, and add a subject.
7. Tap "Photograph the cover" and take the photo.
8. Tap "Save". Go back to the home screen: the header now says 1 book loaded, and the file in the folder has one line.

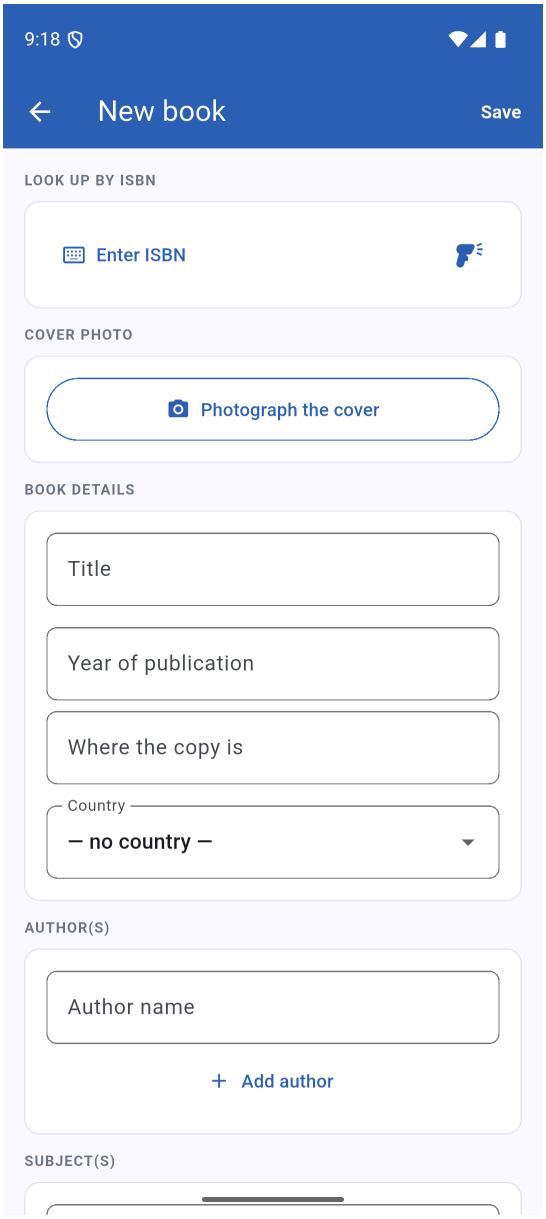


Figura 9: The form open, ready for the first book

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Solução de Problemas

I installed the app and I do not know how to create my biblioteca.txt.

Go to Sync, tap "Select folder" and choose a folder — it can be empty. If there is no biblioteca.txt inside, the row "Create biblioteca.txt in this folder" appears: tap it and the app creates the file.

The picker will not let me choose "My Drive" or the phone's storage.

Android refuses roots to protect your privacy — the "Use this folder" button stays greyed out. Go into a subfolder and pick that. Inside Google Drive it works normally.

The app says "There is no biblioteca.txt in the folder".

Either you picked the wrong folder — then use "Change folder" — or that folder really is new, and then use "Create biblioteca.txt in this folder", just below.

"Add a book" does not open.

There is no file linked, and with no file there is nowhere to write. Sort the folder out under Sync and Add a book works again.

I changed the library on the computer and the phone does not show it.

Tap "Reload file", under Sync. And check that the cloud has finished syncing on the computer's side — the app reads what is on the device.

The covers do not show, although they exist on the computer.

They come from biblioteca.dat, which must be in the SAME folder as biblioteca.txt. On the Mac or Windows, use "Export photos → iCloud Drive" to write it there, then reload here.

The ISBN lookup did not find the book.

That happens with old editions and small print runs. Type the title by hand: nothing else depends on the ISBN.

The app opens in English and the phone is in Portuguese.

The first time it follows the device's language. Tap the "EN" beside the globe, in the header, and choose Português: your choice wins from then on.

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Glossário

biblioteca.dat
The file of cover photos, beside the .txt. Android reads it; it is written by the Mac and iPhone apps.

biblioteca.txt
The file where the catalogue lives. Plain text, one book per line, fields separated by tabs. It is the same file on all four platforms.

ISBN
The 10- or 13-digit number that identifies an edition. It is what the barcode on the back cover carries, and what the app uses to look the book up.

Linking the folder
Telling the app which folder your biblioteca.txt is in — or will be in. Done once, the app remembers.

Reading group
A mark for books discussed in a group. It works as a filter in search.

Root
The top level of a storage: "My Drive", the phone's memory. Android does not let you pick roots in the folder picker; you have to go into a subfolder.

Where the copy is
Where your book physically is — the shelf, the box, the house of whoever borrowed it. Search looks in this field too.

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Referências

- The app's page: https://ruggierow.github.io/biblioteca/
- Manuals for the other platforms (Mac, Windows and iPhone) on the same page.
- The biblioteca.txt format is described in comum/formato-tsv.md, in the project repository.

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